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The fighter who shattered the expectations of millions of UFC fans in India will be in action in early May at the RAC Arena in Perth.

Quillan Salkilld (**pic, facing page**), who demolished India's top UFC prospect Anshul Jubli with a 19-second knockout, will take on Beneil Dariush in a lightweight clash. The event is headlined by Jack Della Maddalena versus Carlos Prates.

Salkilld, a graduate of the Dana White Contender Series, has made rapid strides and earned a co-main event spot in quick time. The Australian announced himself to the UFC world with that win over Jubli early in 2025 and has since put together four consecutive victories, including three finishes.

Meanwhile, Dariush remains one of the most experienced fighters in the division. The 36-year-old made his debut in 2014 and has 23 wins, including 13 finishes. His most notable victories have come against former interim champion Tony Ferguson and Mateusz Gamrot.

This matchup presents a high-stakes crossroads between a surging local hero and a decorated veteran looking to protect his ranking.

Salkilld's rise has been fuelled by a blend of explosive power and opportunistic grappling, evident in his dominant victories over Nasrat Haqparast and Jamie Mullarkey.

With a reach of 1.91 m and a tendency to secure early knockouts, the Perth native is likely to target Dariush's recent vulnerability. Dariush has suffered three defeats in his last five fights, all of them first-round finishes.

However, Dariush remains one of the most technically sound lightweights in the world and represents a significant step up in competition for the young Australian. Despite a recent rough patch against elite contenders, he possesses a strong command of Brazilian jiu-jitsu that Salkilld has yet to encounter.

This fight hinges on whether Salkilld's athleticism can bypass the defensive layers of a master tactician or whether Dariush can use his experience to school the newcomer and prove he still belongs at the top of the division.

A shot at the title

The featherweight title eliminator between Movsar Evloev and Lerone Murphy at UFC London on March 21, 2026 delivered a high-level tactical battle that further cemented Evloev's status as one of the division's most dangerous contenders.

Entering the O2 Arena with a combined undefeated record of 36-0-1, both men fought with the calculated intensity of athletes on the cusp of a championship opportunity.

The bout went to the judges, with Evloev securing a majority decision (48-46, 48-46, 47-47) to move his professional record to 20-0.



Did you know?

UFC Hall of Famer Kevin Randleman (**pic, above**) holds the unfortunate distinction of being the only fighter to be "knocked out" before his fight began.

Scheduled to defend his heavyweight title against Pedro Rizzo at UFC 24 in 2000, Randleman slipped on pipes backstage, hit his head on the concrete, and was rendered unconscious. The main event was cancelled on the spot, marking the only time a UFC championship fight was scrapped due to a backstage knockout.